İlkşen Çetintaş

CHIEF HUMAN RESOURCES OFFICER · EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEMBER

Builds HR from the ground up · Prepares founder-led companies for growth and IPO · Trusted partner to CEOs and Boards

Ankara, Türkiye · linkedin.com/in/ilkşen-çetintaş-b52a6920 · Dual Turkish & EU citizen · open to international relocation

~5,000 employees under Group HR at IC Holding	**4% → 25%** women in tech roles in 1 year · EBRD Gold
~2,000 employees · 11 factories · CHRO since 2021	**IPO 2026** led ŞA-RA's institutionalization to listing

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

CHRO and Executive Committee member with **25+ years** of HR leadership in industrial, defense, energy and global technology companies. Specializes in turning founder-led companies into professionally run corporations: led **ŞA-RA Group's institutionalization up to its 2026 Borsa İstanbul IPO**, ran HR for **~5,000 employees at IC Holding** and led HR at defense company **Nurol Teknoloji**. Trained at **Siemens** and **Turkish Aerospace (TAI)**. Guiding belief: HR earns its seat at the Board table when people decisions are **measurable, fair and tied to business results**. Targeting CHRO, Chief People Officer and Group HR Director roles in Türkiye and internationally.

SIGNATURE ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Prepared ŞA-RA for its IPO:** led the company-wide institutionalization of a ~2,000-employee, 11-factory group up to its **July 2026 Borsa İstanbul listing**, building HR governance, policies, grading, pay and performance systems **from the ground up**.
- **Raised women in technical roles from 4% to 25% in one year** at TREDAŞ, IC Holding's electricity distributor. The program won the **EBRD Gold Award** for Environmental & Social Best Practice (2019).
- **Linked workforce cost to production:** founded a Workforce Productivity & Planning Unit that compares **planned vs. actual production tonnage** with unit labor cost, so the Board makes **capacity decisions based on data**.
- **One fair pay system for ~5,000 employees:** introduced **Hay job evaluation**, common job grades and salary scales across **every IC Holding company**, from construction and energy to airports and tourism.
- **Ran HR as a business at Siemens:** built Siemens Communications Türkiye's HR department, played a key role in turning it into a **profit center**, and led a leadership program that became a **benchmark across Siemens Europe**.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

2025 **Exemplary Woman HR Marvel of the Year**, Global Business Conclave, London

2024 **Global 200 Power Leaders**, among senior executives from 42 countries, Dubai

2019 **EBRD Gold Award**, Environmental & Social Best Practice: led the TREDAŞ gender initiative and was instrumental in securing the award

2018 **Ministry of Energy and Natural Resources Award**: among the top three most successful businesswomen in mining and energy

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ŞA-RA Group (ŞA-RA Enerji İnşaat Tic. ve San. A.Ş.) · Ankara — 2021 – Present

Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) · Executive Committee Member

Energy-infrastructure manufacturer founded in 1985: steel structures, power-line hardware and galvanizing; 11 factories, projects in 120+ countries, ~2,000 employees. Listed on Borsa İstanbul in July 2026.

- **Road to IPO:** led the company-wide institutionalization and culture change that brought the group to its **2026 public listing**, building HR policies, processes and systems **from the ground up**.
- **HR as a strategic function:** moved HR from approving paperwork to a function accountable for **governance, productivity and business results**.

- **Board partner:** prepare productivity, workforce-cost and risk analyses that help the **Board and Executive Committee** decide on workforce and capacity.
- **Productivity unit:** founded and lead the Workforce Productivity & Planning Unit, linking **production tonnage, unit labor cost and workforce mix**.
- **Fair pay:** built a **grade- and band-based salary structure** for all Group companies, checked every role against it and proposed adjustments to improve **internal pay equity**.
- **Pay for performance:** designed goal scorecards (department, shared and personal goals) and a **variable pay model** that links bonuses to results, competencies and talent reviews.
- **Digital HR:** built an **e-HR platform inside the company ERP**, bringing goals, competency assessments and approvals into one system.
- **Talent and governance:** set up workforce planning, recruitment, **succession**, career planning and leadership development; built an HR governance framework in line with labor law; prepare the annual HR budget.

Nurol Teknoloji A.Ş. · Ankara 2019 – 2021

Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO)

Defense-technology company of Nurol Holding: ballistic ceramics and armor for personnel, vehicles and aircraft.

- **Defense HR:** led HR strategy in a tightly regulated defense company with **large blue-collar teams**, keeping people plans in step with growth and innovation goals.
- **Succession:** built performance, talent and reward systems that strengthened the **leadership pipeline for critical technical roles**; introduced competency-based learning.
- **Early careers and diversity:** launched diversity-focused internships and **university–industry programs** to grow the early-career talent pipeline.
- **HR technology:** played a direct role in SAP integration and the **SAP SuccessFactors** rollout.

IC Holding (IC İbrahim Çeçen Yatırım Holding) · Ankara 2013 – 2019

Deputy General Manager, Human Resources

Diversified Turkish group: construction and infrastructure (incl. the Yavuz Sultan Selim Bridge and Northern Marmara Motorway), energy (TREDAŞ), airports, tourism and industry; ~5,000 employees.

- **Gender diversity:** led the TREDAŞ initiative that raised women in technical roles from **4% to 25% in one year** (**EBRD Gold Award 2019**).
- **Job evaluation:** ran **Hay job evaluations in all holding companies** and set common job grades and salary scales for consistent, fair pay decisions.
- **Workforce cost:** led HR strategy and **workforce cost planning**; prepared HR budgets (salaries, variable pay, social security, severance, benefits, training).
- **Performance and reward:** designed competency management and **variable pay scorecards** that link performance directly to reward.
- **HR digitalization:** led the **SAP-based HR rollout** and workforce analytics for clearer data and better decisions.

TED University · Ankara 2011 – 2013

HR Director

Foundation university of the Turkish Education Association (TED); joined before its 2012 academic launch.

- Built the university's **HR function and governance from scratch** as part of the founding team.

Swissôtel Ankara · Ankara 2009 – 2011

HR Director · Executive Committee Member

Five-star hotel of the Swissôtel Hotels & Resorts brand.

- Led talent development and change programs as a member of the hotel's **Executive Committee**.

Siemens Communications, Türkiye 1996 – 2006

Group Human Resources Manager

Siemens Industries Inc.: Siemens' telecommunications business in Türkiye (carrier networks, enterprise networks, mobile devices).

- **HR as a profit center:** set up and led the HR department; played a key role in turning it from a service unit into a **profit center** with internal service agreements and pricing.

- **Leadership Excellence:** led the Siemens Leadership Excellence program in Türkiye, which became a **benchmark across Siemens Europe**.
- **Reward:** led company-wide **job evaluation (CRG, Hay)**, built grade- and band-based pay structures and linked scorecards to variable pay.
- **Talent systems:** set up **assessment and development centers**, onboarding and outplacement programs; rolled out the global recruitment portal in Türkiye; contributed to SAP HR integration.

Turkish Aerospace Industries (TAI) · Ankara 1988 – 1996

Senior HR Lead

Türkiye's national aerospace company, founded in 1984 for F-16 co-production.

- Contributed to HR policy for job evaluation, salary scales, wage policy, salary surveys, performance and reward; ran appraisal and development workshops for first-line and middle managers.

LEADERSHIP APPROACH

- **Institutions outlast founders:** clear governance and succession let a company grow (**ŞA-RA, road to IPO**).
- **Measure what matters:** people decisions rest on data (**Workforce Productivity Unit**).
- **Fair systems build trust:** transparent grades, goals and rewards (**IC Holding, Siemens, ŞA-RA**).
- **HR answers for results:** run HR like a business (**Siemens HR as a profit center**).
- **Diversity with targets:** inclusion managed like any KPI (**4% → 25%, EBRD Gold**).

CORE COMPETENCIES

- People & HR Strategy
- Business & Culture Transformation
- HR Governance & People Risk
- Job Evaluation (Hay, CRG)
- Performance & Variable Pay
- Succession & Career Planning
- Culture & Employee Engagement
- HR Digital Transformation & HRIS
- Employment Law Compliance
- HR Operating Model Design
- Change Management
- Compensation & Benefits
- Grading & Salary Structures
- Strategic Workforce Planning
- Talent Management
- Diversity, Equity & Inclusion
- SAP & SAP SuccessFactors
- Multi-site & Blue-collar Workforces
- Organizational Effectiveness
- Board & Stakeholder Management
- Reward Strategy & Total Rewards
- Internal Pay Equity
- Workforce Cost & Productivity
- Leadership Development
- Talent Acquisition & Early Careers
- People Analytics
- Assessment & Development Centers

EDUCATION

Middle East Technical University (METU), Bachelor's Degree in Management — Ankara

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages	Turkish (native) · English (advanced) · German (good working proficiency)
Mobility	Dual Turkish & EU citizen; open to relocation within Türkiye and internationally

REFERENCES

Senior references (TED, Siemens) available on request.